

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Less Salt, Better Health

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 19

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - Why people use salt

No.	Sentence
1	Salt brings out the _____ of ingredients.
2	The body needs at least 1g of salt daily for _____.
3	Average daily salt intake is _____.
4	Salting meat for long journeys helped prevent food _____.
5	The old salting practice also affected _____, not only meat.
6	It helped people have enough to eat in the long _____.
7	The body responds by _____.
8	High blood pressure may eventually lead to _____.
9	British laws require _____ to reduce the salt they use.
10	For flavour without added salt, people can try _____.

11 What tension does the opening discussion establish about eating salt?

- A It is useful for flavour, but its health effects depend mainly on which food contains it.
- B The body needs some, but many people consume amounts that raise health risks.
- C It helps the body survive, but a teaspoon is required every day.
- D It improves ingredients, but its main danger comes from traditional preserved foods.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 12 **What does the figure given for Kazakhstan show in relation to the WHO guidance quoted in the programme?**
- A The average intake there is only slightly above the guidance.
 - B The average intake there is close to the amount needed for survival.
 - C The average intake there is roughly twice the British recommendation.
 - D The average intake there is more than three times the amount in the WHO guidance.
- 13 **Why did salting meat become part of the tradition described by the Kazakh interviewee?**
- A People had to carry meat while travelling for long periods.
 - B People needed meat to taste stronger than dairy products.
 - C People wanted to replace the milk products they carried.
 - D People had begun to buy more processed food while travelling.
- 14 **What contrast marks the shift from the historical discussion to modern health concerns?**
- A Traditional uses of salt explain why modern processed food is generally safe.
 - B A useful preservation method should determine today's daily intake target.
 - C Salt has had practical value, while high intake today remains a health concern.
 - D Health risks mean the historical value of salting food should be dismissed.
- 15 **According to the explanation of the body's response, why can excess salt increase strain on the heart?**
- A The body releases water, so the heart must replace lost liquid.
 - B Salt directly damages the heart before blood pressure changes.
 - C The body stores less liquid, so blood pressure rises quickly.
 - D The body keeps more water, so the heart pumps more liquid.
- 16 **How do the Australian and British responses described in the programme differ?**
- A Australia restricts food companies; Britain leaves the daily amount for individual consumers to decide.
 - B Australia lowered its daily guidance; Britain also required companies to reduce salt in food.
 - C Australia recommends 5g per day; Britain sets a higher target of 6g for its population.
 - D Australia limits salt in dairy products; Britain directs its restrictions chiefly at traditionally preserved meat.

- 17 **What is the nutrition professor's main objection to debating whether the limit should be 5g or 6g?**
- A It can distract from widespread high intake and its early health consequences.
 - B It gives food companies too little time to change their products.
 - C It overlooks the fact that 1g is the minimum needed for survival.
 - D It assumes every country has exactly the same average intake.
- 18 **A country has a strong tradition of using salt to preserve food. Which response would best fit the professor's view?**
- A Keep the traditional intake because preservation has a useful history.
 - B Set the same exact reduction method used by every other country.
 - C Design a way to address high intake that suits the local culture.
 - D Focus first on settling whether 5g or 6g is the correct number.
- 19 **What practical purpose do herbs and spices serve in the final advice?**
- A They preserve food for longer without changing its taste.
 - B They offer a way to add flavour when using less salt.
 - C They help the body remove water retained after a salty meal.
 - D They make processed food meet the British legal standard.